

SALES TRAINING DEBRIEF · SESSION 3

Obsession is the Multiplier. Balance is the Scam.

Session led by Corie Dawson, Director

Monday 11 May 2026 · Internal sales-team summary

The thesis in one line

Wednesday gave us the choreography. Friday gave us the operating system. This session strips the topic right back to its foundation: nothing you've been taught matters unless you bring obsessive-level effort to applying it. Obsession is the multiplier on everything. You cannot be coached into it — but you have proven, in other parts of your life, that you already know how to be obsessed. Today is about redirecting that capability.

“I can't train obsession. I can only help you understand it.” — Corie

1. The continuity rule — training is cumulative

The session opened with a hard reset on what it means to attend training. Each session builds on the last. Showing up without having reviewed the previous week's notes is not a neutral act — it is a deliberate decision to start every meeting from scratch, which forces the trainer to re-cover ground and forces you to re-learn material you should already have absorbed.

“I gave you training last week. I gave you a printout. And you can't remember what we discussed. Not trying to pick on anyone — just explaining the facts.” — Corie

The judo analogy

A judo coach teaches you a grappling technique, then says: practise this all week, come back next week, and we'll build the next lesson on top of it. Nobody on the planet would show up to that second class without having drilled the move all week. Yet that is exactly what happens in sales training. The mindset rule: treat every coaching session like a judo lesson — drill the material between sessions, or it is wasted time for everyone in the room.

2. The effort mismatch audit

A central exercise in the session: a forensic look at where reps have, in other parts of their lives, demonstrated capacity for obsessive effort. Three universal examples surfaced.

Where reps already prove they can be obsessed

- **University.** Tens of thousands of dollars invested. Late nights, rushed assignments handed in at 2 a.m., four years of grinding. Often paid for personally. Often for a qualification that doesn't even apply to the rep's current job.
- **Sport / a serious hobby.** National-level performance in a sport requires obsessive training schedules — every meal, every late night, every weekend optimised around the goal. People do this voluntarily, for years.
- **Dating.** Two minutes after meeting a person worth pursuing, reps remember everything — names, preferences, family details, dog breeds. Effort is instant and obsessive.

The uncomfortable question

Every rep in the room has demonstrated obsessive-level effort in at least one of those three areas. Often all three. So the question is no longer "can you be obsessed?" — that's been answered. The question is: why are you choosing NOT to be obsessed about the one thing that actually pays your bills and shapes your decade?

"You've got the capabilities. You've used it for long periods with no one chasing you. I just don't understand why you won't harness it for the thing that affects you day-to-day." — Corie

3. Effort vs results — the only thing your manager actually measures

A common defensive position when results are bad is to point at hours worked: "I'm doing my best, I'm staying late, I'm trying hard." Corie's framing flatly rejects this as a defence.

"I'm not interested in how hard you work. I'm just interested in whether you're achieving the results." — Corie

The distinction matters because hours-worked is a comforting metric. It gives you a story to tell yourself when results aren't there: "well, I tried." Outcome-based measurement removes that escape. Either the deals closed or they didn't. Either the quiz was passed or it wasn't. Either the prospect knows your numbers or they don't. Hours don't enter the conversation.

4. The disrespect framework

A deliberately blunt frame from the session: showing up unprepared is not a personal failing — it is disrespect. To the trainer, to the team, and (most importantly) to your own future self. Excuses for not preparing — being busy, family commitments, "I didn't have time" — all share one quiet message: "this thing you're investing in me is not worth the same effort I'd give to other things."

How disrespect actually presents

- Showing up without having read the notes from the last session.

- Failing to recall, when asked, what was covered the previous week.
- Blaming external circumstances for not preparing ("I was with family," "I didn't have time").
- Engaging only with the parts of training that feel comfortable.
- Going through the motions in role-plays without committing.

"Don't hide behind external commitments. That's the coward's way. Be honest with yourself: I should have prioritised it. That's a harder sentence to say — but it's the only honest one." — Corie (paraphrased)

5. Honesty, Integrity, Loyalty

Three principles that come up repeatedly across sessions. They sound generic until you actually apply them.

Principle	What it actually means in practice
Honesty	Tell yourself the truth about your effort — even when it's uncomfortable. Most reps lie to themselves about how much they prepared, how seriously they take the work, and whether they really believe the product. That self-deception is the first blockage to break.
Integrity	Match your behaviour to your stated intentions. If you say you want to be top-performer, your calendar and your prep work should reflect it. If they don't, your stated intentions are decoration.
Loyalty	Loyalty to the brand, the product, and the team. If you don't fully believe in what you're selling, the customer will feel it. Loyalty is built through belief — and belief is built through research, not pep talks.

6. "Balance is a scam" — the comforting story average people tell

A confronting segment of the session: the cultural idea of "work-life balance" is, in Corie's view, a comforting story average people tell themselves to justify why they're not getting the outcomes they say they want. The people building real wealth, real businesses, real freedom — none of them describe their journey as "balanced."

"Balance is the biggest scam. You don't win Judo championships across the globe by being un-obsessed and just doing judo. You don't build planes and boats and beach houses by working 9-to-5 for someone else." — Corie

The reframe

This isn't a recommendation to work 100-hour weeks indefinitely. It's a recommendation to be honest: if you want the average outcome, run an average schedule. If you want an outlier outcome, accept an outlier schedule for the period of your life where it matters most. Don't take an average effort and expect an extraordinary result.

7. The competition you can't see

A pointed illustration in the session: imagine a tradesman apprentice on \$25/hour, working a full day on a building site, then driving Uber until midnight to send money to family overseas. Your closest competitor isn't the rep one desk away — it's that person. They are obsessed by necessity. They have no plan B.

Where they'll be in 10 years

- Multiple investment properties.
- A small business they own outright.
- Extended family pooling capital with them, accelerating the next purchase.
- A network of similarly-obsessed peers, all compounding.

Meanwhile, the complacent local rep with a degree, a job, and a roof — same place. Same role. Same pay band. The difference is not intelligence. It is not opportunity. It is obsession.

8. The most dangerous sentence: "I'm already set up"

Corie called this out as the single most damaging mindset a rep can carry: the belief that you've already arrived. "I've got a house. I'm doing okay. I don't need to grind anymore."

"'I'm already set up' is the most damaging statement, because you believe it — and you know it's true at this moment in time. That's what makes it so dangerous." — Corie

The trap is that the statement might be technically accurate today. You ARE doing okay relative to where you started. But the moment you accept that frame, you stop running the magnets. You stop pulling success in. You stop pushing failure away. And in 5–10 years, the people who never accepted that frame have lapped you — and there's no catching back up.

9. The 5% career ceiling

A blunt observation about how employment compensation actually works.

"You don't get planes and boats and beach houses by working for someone. From an employee pay grade, you grow maybe 5% a year. That's the ceiling. Anything beyond that requires you to work for yourself in some form." — Corie (paraphrased)

This isn't a recommendation to quit and start a business tomorrow. It is recommendation to understand the structure of the game you're playing. Employment growth is linear and

bounded. Ownership growth — taking equity in your work, building skills that compound, building reputation and network — is exponential and unbounded. The question is whether you're positioning for the bounded outcome or the unbounded one.

10. Tactical sidebar — estimating turnover for trade businesses

The tactical portion at the start of the session. A refinement of the turnover formula introduced in Session 2.

The rule

- **Service-based business (consultants, agencies, advisory):** roughly \$100,000 turnover per staff member.
- **Trade-based business (anything with trucks, materials, physical product):** multiply that by ~3x — so roughly \$300,000 per staff member.

Why the multiplier

Trade businesses pass through materials, equipment, and sub-contractor costs that service businesses don't. A skip-bin company with 9 staff isn't turning over \$900k — it's probably turning over \$2–3M, with margins more like 25–30% rather than 70%+ for services. If you walk in pricing for a \$900k business when they're actually doing \$3M, you have under-pitched by 70%.

Worked example from the session

Commercial air-conditioning company, 20 staff, trade business. Service-business math: $20 \times \$100k = \$2M$ turnover. Trade adjustment: $\times 3 = \$6M$ turnover (with seasonal variation to \$8M). Weekly value: $\$6M \div 50 \text{ weeks} = \$120k$ per week. Pricing anchor for our package: a small fraction of that weekly figure.

11. Behaviours to change this week

1. **Treat training as cumulative.** Before every session, re-read the notes from the last one. If you can't answer a question about last week's material in 5 seconds flat, you have not prepared.
2. **Audit your effort.** Where in your life have you been obsessed? Make the list — university, sport, dating, a hobby. Then ask honestly: am I bringing that level of obsession to my career, or am I rationing it for everything else?
3. **Stop measuring yourself by hours.** Hours worked is irrelevant. Results closed is the only metric. If the deals aren't closing, the hours don't count.
4. **Kill the "I'm already set up" thought.** The moment you catch yourself thinking it, treat it as a warning siren. Complacency at this stage of your career is more dangerous than failure.
5. **Apply the trade-business multiplier.** Service business: \$100k/staff. Trade business: ~\$300k/staff. Default to the higher end and pitch from there.

6. **Take responsibility for your prep.** "I was busy" is a coward's sentence. The honest sentence is "I should have prioritised it." Use the honest one. It's harder. It's also the only one that leads to change.
7. **Pick your obsession deliberately.** You only have so much obsession to give. Choose where to spend it. If it's not going to your career — at least be honest with yourself about the trade-off.

Final reminder. Sessions 1 and 2 gave you scripts and frameworks. This session is the answer to why those scripts aren't closing deals for you yet. Frameworks without obsession produce mediocre results. Obsession without frameworks produces burnout. Both together produce outliers. The work this week is on your obsession — there's nothing left to teach until that's settled.